

Sivasankaramoorthy R – IST

Barclays Intern

About the company:

Barclays plc is a British multinational universal bank headquartered in London, England, aiming to be a UK-centered leader in global finance. With a focus on operational excellence, customer satisfaction, and robust liquidity and risk management, Barclays serves a diverse clientele through five key divisions: Barclays UK, Barclays Investment Bank, Barclays UK Corporate Bank, Barclays Private Bank and Wealth Management, and Barclays US Consumer Bank. Over the next three years, the bank is committed to enhancing its performance by making itself Simpler, Better, and More balanced. With a trusted brand and a customer base of over 20 million in the UK and the US, Barclays is dedicated to creating a better financial future for its customers, clients, and communities while ensuring predictable, attractive returns for shareholders.

About the role:

Technology summer intern 2025

Work on projects & tech on developing highly scalable application. Design and develop Micro services, GUI, Server components. Implement Functional solutions, unit test & coordinate releases and where applicable contribute to design sessions. Interact with end users & product owner to understand their requirements and build solution pertaining to that. Work as a part of a local team and liaise regularly with colleagues in other regions. Provide support to for the applications BAU work as needed.

Duration: 8 weeks

Overview of the process:

Overall process consists of

- Online round(MCQ questions & coding question & SQL question)
- Interview round -I (Technical & HR)
- Interview round -II (Based on resume)

Online round:

- There are 14 questions: 12 MCQ questions, one coding question, and one SQL question.
- The MCQ questions cover topics from operating systems, SQL queries, databases, and programming languages such as C++, Java, and pseudocode.
- The SQL question is simple and can be solved by joining the tables.
- Everyone has a common tricky coding question based on strings.

- Given two strings, String A is a non-empty string, and String B consists of 'T' and 'F'. The task is to return a resultant string if a particular index in String B has 'T' and the resultant string has String A as a substring at that index.
- Twenty-nine students were shortlisted for the interview round. The results were announced two days later.
- Solve the coding question and sql question as it carries more marks and try to make all the MCQ questions is enough to get selected for the next round.

Interview round -I (Technical & HR):

- This round started at 10:30 AM, and naturally, the interview began with introductions.
- I was feeling frustrated at the start, but the panel member (she) tried to calm my nerves.
- She reviewed my resume and asked me to explain my LLM project using system architecture. Since I am currently working on that project, I was able to explain it clearly.
- I was asked questions about operating systems , oops and Java basics.
- I presented merge sort and binary search, including code and explanations, addressing aspects like time complexity as well.
- Two SQL queries were posed, and I answered all the technical questions quite well.
- As she moved into the HR round, she began asking questions about my family and hobbies.
- She asked me two HR questions, and I answered them close to her expectations. Even though I felt I had responded well, she pointed out some flaws in my answers, which caused me to doubt myself.
- The questions were: "What would you do as a team leader when you find out a bug on the penultimate day of project submission to the stakeholder?" and "What would you do as a team leader if you forgot your login access card on the day of model deployment?"
- Finally, she asked if I had any questions. I came up with several, such as, "What are the expectations when you join Barclays, and will they be fulfilled?" I also posed a point-of-view question and asked her to reminisce about her college days. This part seemed to change her perspective during the HR round.
- My interview lasted more than an hour.

Interview round - II(based on my resume):

- This round focused on my resume.
- I was asked about the purpose of my project, the technology stack used, and the number of members involved in the project.
- She inquired about what I would do if I lost my code and how I would handle a situation where a teammate wasn't performing well.

- She also asked whether I had any knowledge of stocks, given that Barclays is a financial company. I honestly replied that I have a basic understanding of finances.
- I responded to all the questions very well.
- This round helped me build my confidence.
- I was able to address some technical aspects effectively.
- Overall, I felt that my responses contributed positively to the interview.
- This round will last for 20 mins.

Barclays HR team announced 14 members were shortlisted. And I was one of them.

My preparations and Key insights:

- I started my coding preparation during my 4th semester holidays. While it felt a bit late, I reminded myself that it's never too late to begin, and I focused on working through data structures and algorithms (DSA) while recalling everything before my interview.
- It's essential to have a solid understanding of the company you're interviewing with. For instance, Barclays has values encapsulated in the acronym RISES, and they expect candidates to align with these values.
- Being truthful about your resume is crucial. Highlight only the most relevant experiences and skills, and approach the interview with confidence, as if you truly believe you are the right fit for the position.
- I utilized ACM CODE documents for my preparation and participated in numerous coding competitions, which I found incredibly beneficial. I highly recommend engaging in all kinds of technical events, as they provide valuable experience.
- Don't hesitate to ask questions if you're unsure about something. This shows your eagerness to understand and learn, which can positively attract the interviewer's attention.
- When answering HR-related questions, ensure that you provide the best possible solutions. Take your time to formulate your responses.
- Develop your communication skills. Even if you feel nervous and start to ramble, make sure to convey enough information for the interviewer to understand your thoughts clearly. Being articulate can leave a lasting impression.
- Ultimately, my honesty regarding my resume and the skills I demonstrated during the interview played a significant role in securing my internship.

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All the best for your preparations!!